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Table 1.7: Economic importance of Bacteria		
Beneficial aspects	**Bacteria**	**Role**
1. Soil fertility		
Ammonification	1. *Bacillus ramosus* 2. *Bacillus mycoides*	Convert complex proteins in the dead bodies of plants and animals into ammonia which is later converted into ammonium salt
Nitrification	1. *Nitrobacter* 2. *Nitrosomonas*	Convert ammonium salts into nitrites and nitrates
Nitrogen fixation	1. *Azotobacter* 2. *Clostridium* 3. *Rhizobium*	(i) Converting atmospheric nitrogen into organic nitrogen (ii) The nitrogenous compounds are also oxidized to nitrogen (iii) All these activities of bacteria increase soil fertility
2. Antibiotics		
1. Streptomycin	*Streptomyces griseus*	It cures urinary infections, tuberculosis, meningitis and pneumonia
2. Aureomycin	*Streptomyces aureofaciens*	It is used as a medicine to treat whooping cough and eye infections
3. Chloromycetin	*Streptomyces venezuelae*	It cure typhoid fever
4. Bacitracin	*Bacillus licheniformis*	It is used to treat syphilis
5. Polymyxin	*Bacillus polymyxa*	It cure some bacterial diseases
3. Industrial Uses		
1. Lactic acid	*Streptococcus lactis* and *Lactobacillus bulgaricus*	Convert milk sugar lactose into lactic acid
2. Butter	*Streptococcus lactis, Leuconostoc citrovorum*	Convert milk into butter, cheese, curd and yoghurt
3. cheese	*Lactobacillus acidophobus, Lactobacillus lactis*	
4. Curd	*Lactobacillus lactis*	
5. Yoghurt	*Lactobacillus bulgaricus*	
6. Vinegar (Acetic acid)	*Acetobacter aceti*	This bacteria oxidizes ethyl alcohol obtained from molasses by fermentation to vinegar(acetic acid)

(Continued)